

Ministry of Forests, Lands, Natural Resource Operations and Rural Development

Flood Warning – Chilcotin (UPGRADED)

Issued: 9:30am June 30, 2021

The River Forecast Centre is **upgrading** to a **Flood Warning** for:

- **Chilcotin, including Taseko River, Chilko River, Chilcotin River, Big Creek and surrounding tributaries draining from the Chilcotin Mountains**

Extremely hot temperatures continue in the Chilcotin region and are triggering an unprecedented amount of snowmelt at the higher elevations. Automated snow weather stations (1300-1600m) are snow-free, however satellite analysis is indicating snow coverage in upper elevations throughout the region. The few automated snow weather stations in the province with remaining snowpack are melting at extraordinary rates of 50-100 mm per day of snow water equivalent. Environment and Climate Change Canada (ECCC) forecasts one more extremely hot day today for the Chilcotin region. Temperatures are forecast to cool tomorrow but remain well above normal for this time of year. Due to the delay of flows coming out of the larger lake systems (e.g. Chilko Lake and Taseko Lakes) downstream rivers are forecast to continue rising into the weekend.

The status of rivers in the region as of 09:00 PDT today:

- Chilcotin River near Hanceville (Water Survey of Canada gauge 08MB012) is currently flowing at approximately 414 m³/s (between 10 and 20-year flow) and continues to rise.
- Taseko River near the outlet of Taseko Lake (08GE002) is estimated to be flowing at approximately 241 m³/s (20-year flow) and continues to rise.
- The Chilko River near Redstone (08MA001) is currently flowing at approximately 463 m³/s (between 20 and 50-year) and continues to rise.

The updated CLEVER Model results will be available later this morning and can be found at:

http://bcrfc.env.gov.bc.ca/freshet/map_clever.html

The public is advised to stay clear of the fast-flowing rivers and potentially unstable riverbanks during the high-streamflow period.

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The [River Forecast Centre](#) continues to monitor the conditions and will provide updates as conditions warrant.

BC River Forecast Centre

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A **High Streamflow Advisory** means that river levels are rising or expected to rise rapidly, but that no major flooding is expected. Minor flooding in low-lying areas is possible.

A **Flood Watch** means that river levels are rising and will approach or may exceed bankfull. Flooding of areas adjacent to affected rivers may occur.

A **Flood Warning** means that river levels have exceeded bankfull or will exceed bankfull imminently, and that flooding of areas adjacent to the rivers affected will result.